

# High-Precision Temperature Measurement for PT100: A Comparative Model Analysis

Dr. G.V.V. Sharma,  
Puni Aditya, Vivek K. Kumar,  
Jnanesh S.K., Shreyas Goud Burra  
Department of Electrical Engineering,  
Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad,  
Kandi, India 502284  
gadepall@ee.iith.ac.in

**Abstract**—Resistance Temperature Detectors (RTDs), specifically the PT100, are widely favored in industrial applications for their linearity and stability. This report details the calibration and characterization of a PT100 sensor by comparing two hardware signal conditioning setups: a simple voltage divider and a precision Wheatstone bridge interfaced with an ADS1115 ADC. We first analyze the suitability of a quadratic Least Squares (LSQ) model, grounded in the theoretical Callendar-Van Dusen equation. We then compare the accuracy of three different regression approaches for the superior Wheatstone bridge data: the LSQ quadratic, a Stochastic Gradient Descent (SGD) trained model, and a non-linear Random Forest Regressor. The coefficients, mathematical formulations, and validation accuracy for each model are presented, demonstrating that machine learning approaches can augment traditional calibration methods.

## I. INTRODUCTION

Temperature measurement is a fundamental requirement in process control, automotive systems, and instrumentation. Among the various contact temperature sensors available, the Platinum Resistance Temperature Detector (RTD), commonly known as the PT100, is considered the standard for precision thermometry [1].

### A. Fundamental Principles

The PT100 is defined by a nominal resistance of  $100\ \Omega$  at  $0^\circ\text{C}$ . Unlike thermocouples which generate a voltage, RTDs differ in that they operate by changing electrical resistance in direct proportion to temperature changes [2]. This relationship is inherently non-linear over wide ranges, though it is highly predictable. The resistance  $R(t)$  at temperature  $t$  is governed by the Callendar-Van Dusen equation [3]:

$$R(t) = R_0(1 + At + Bt^2) \quad (1)$$

for temperatures  $t > 0^\circ\text{C}$ , where  $A$  and  $B$  are standard coefficients. This quadratic physical relationship serves as the theoretical justification for using Quadratic Least Squares (LSQ) models in this study.

### B. Measurement Challenges

While PT100 sensors offer high stability, the resistance change is relatively small ( $\approx 0.385\ \Omega/^\circ\text{C}$ ). Consequently, accurate reading requires precise signal conditioning to convert resistance changes into measurable voltage levels [4]. This

project aims to optimize this conversion by analyzing different hardware front-ends and software regression models [5] to find an optimal solution for high-precision, low-cost temperature sensing.

## II. HARDWARE SETUP

Two main analog front-ends were tested to evaluate the trade-off between circuit complexity and measurement accuracy:

- **Setup 1: High-Precision Wheatstone Bridge with ADC.** This uses a Wheatstone bridge configuration coupled with an external 16-bit ADS1115 ADC [6]. This setup allows for differential measurement, significantly reducing noise and common-mode errors.
- **Setup 2: Simple Voltage Divider.** This uses a simple voltage divider utilizing the Arduino's internal 10-bit ADC.

### A. Component Lists

The components required for both analog front-ends are listed below, detailing the specific parts used for high-accuracy and cost-effective implementations.

TABLE I  
COMPONENT LIST

| Component                                              | Qty. | Description                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Arduino Uno                                            | 1    | Microcontroller for processing and control.                                                            |
| ADS1115 ADC                                            | 1    | 16-bit external ADC for high-precision voltage measurement.                                            |
| PT100 RTD Sensor                                       | 1    | Platinum resistance thermometer.                                                                       |
| 100 $\Omega$ Resistor                                  | 1    | Precision resistor for Wheatstone bridge.                                                              |
| 4k $\Omega$ Resistors                                  | 2    | Resistors for Wheatstone bridge.                                                                       |
| JHD 162A Parallel LCD                                  | 1    | For displaying the final temperature.                                                                  |
| 22k $\Omega$ Potentiometer                             | 1    | To adjust the contrast of the LCD.                                                                     |
| Breadboard                                             | 1    | For creating solderless circuit connections.                                                           |
| Jumper Wires                                           | Set  | For connecting all the components.                                                                     |
| Pen Thermometer<br>$\leq 0.1^\circ\text{C}$ resolution | 1    | Used for training purpose and as a reference.                                                          |
| Kettle/Heater with water                               | 1    | To heat the water, so that training data corresponding to a wide range of temperatures can be obtained |

## B. Connection Schematics and Diagrams

1) *Circuit Schematic*: The complete circuit schematic for the high-precision Wheatstone bridge setup is illustrated in Figure 1.

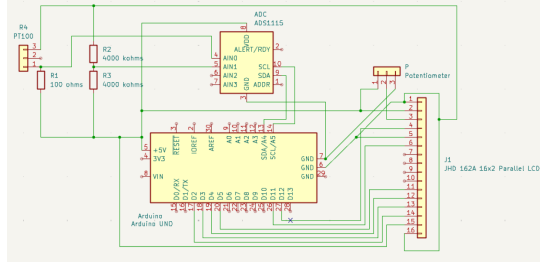


Fig. 1. Circuit Schematic of the High-Precision Wheatstone Bridge (Setup 1)

2) *ADS1115 ADC Connections*: The connection details for integrating the external 16-bit ADS1115 ADC are critical for differential measurement accuracy.

TABLE II  
ADS1115 CONNECTIONS

| ADS1115 Pin | Arduino Pin                                               | Purpose                            |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| VDD         | 5V                                                        | Power Supply                       |
| GND         | GND                                                       | Common Ground                      |
| SCL         | A5 (SCL)                                                  | I2C Clock Line                     |
| SDA         | A4 (SDA)                                                  | I2C Data Line                      |
| A0          | Input from Voltage Divider Node (between PT100 and R_REF) | Reading Voltage                    |
| A1          | Junction between the two 4kΩ resistors                    | Reference for differential reading |

3) *LCD Display Connections*: A standard JHD 162A Parallel Liquid Crystal Display (LCD) was used for real-time temperature output in both setups.

TABLE III  
LCD CONNECTIONS

| LCD Pin     | Arduino Pin              |
|-------------|--------------------------|
| VSS         | GND                      |
| VDD         | 5V                       |
| V0          | Potentiometer Middle Pin |
| RS          | Digital 12               |
| RW          | GND                      |
| E           | Digital 11               |
| D4          | Digital 5                |
| D5          | Digital 4                |
| D6          | Digital 3                |
| D7          | Digital 2                |
| A (Anode)   | 5V                       |
| K (Cathode) | GND                      |

Component lists and connection diagrams are provided in the appendix tables.

## III. MODELS USED

This report details the development and evaluation of several regression models for predicting sensor output. Specifically, we focus on two scenarios: predicting

temperature from voltage using a Wheatstone bridge with ADC, and predicting resistance from voltage using a voltage divider without ADC. We investigate Random Forest Regressor [7], Inverse Quadratic Least Squares (LSQ), Direct LSQ, and Stochastic Gradient Descent (SGD) approaches. The models were implemented using Python and the scikit-learn. The source code corresponding to the training and evaluation pipelines are hosted at:

[https://github.com/gadepall/pt100/blob/main/codes/models/PT100\\_models.ipynb](https://github.com/gadepall/pt100/blob/main/codes/models/PT100_models.ipynb)

## IV. MODEL EVALUATION AND COMPARISON

This section presents the evaluation of the trained models and a comparison of their performance based on Mean Squared Error (MSE) and R-squared (R2) metrics.

### A. Model Explanations

1) *Inverse LSQ (Quadratic) for Voltage Divider without ADC*: This model approximates the relationship between resistance ( $Y$ ) and voltage ( $X$ ) from the voltage divider circuit as  $X = aY^2 + bY + c$ . The fitted equation for the Voltage Divider is:

$$X = -0.000014990Y^2 + 0.005589496Y + 2.526066163$$

The coefficients are determined through linear least squares regression [5]. The model predicts resistance ( $Y$ ) from measured voltage ( $X$ ) using the positive root of the quadratic equation:

$$Y = \frac{-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4a(c - X)}}{2a}$$

This method is suitable for circuits where the voltage-resistance relationship can be approximated quadratically.

2) *Inverse LSQ (Quadratic) for Wheatstone with ADC*: This model approaches the Wheatstone bridge problem by fitting a quadratic equation of the form  $X = aY^2 + bY + c$ , where  $Y$  is temperature and  $X$  is voltage. The fitted equation for the Wheatstone bridge is:

$$X = -0.000006744Y^2 + 0.004344843Y + 0.056019368$$

To predict  $Y$  from a given  $X$ , we use the quadratic formula:

$$Y = \frac{-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4a(c - X)}}{2a}$$

This method aligns with the physical properties described by the Callendar-Van Dusen equation [3].

3) *LSQ (Quadratic) for Wheatstone with ADC*: This model applies a standard quadratic fit directly mapping voltage to temperature, expressed as  $Y = aX^2 + bX + c$ . Unlike the inverse models, this approach predicts temperature ( $Y$ ) directly from the voltage ( $X$ ) without requiring the use of the quadratic formula for inversion during the prediction phase.

- **Fitted Equation:**  $Y = aX^2 + bX + c$
- **Coefficients:**

$$a = 190.226107678$$

$$b = 173.380527679$$

$$c = -7.072446221$$

4) *Stochastic Gradient Descent (SGD) Regressor (Wheatstone with ADC)*: The SGD Regressor is a linear model trained with Stochastic Gradient Descent [7]. Due to its sensitivity to feature scaling, both the input features (X) and the target variable (Y) were scaled using StandardScaler before training. The predictions were then inverse-transformed back to the original scale for evaluation.

5) *Inverse SGD Regressor (Wheatstone with ADC)*: This model utilizes Stochastic Gradient Descent to learn the inverse relationship, where voltage (X) is the target and temperature (Y) is the feature ( $X = f(Y)$ ). Similar to the Inverse LSQ approach, the model learns to predict voltage from temperature. During inference, the temperature is derived by numerically inverting the learned function.

6) *Random Forest Regressor (Wheatstone with ADC)*: The Random Forest Regressor is an ensemble learning method that constructs a multitude of decision trees during training [7]. For regression tasks, it averages the predictions of individual trees to produce a more stable and accurate prediction. This model was applied to predict temperature (Y) from voltage (X) directly, leveraging its ability to capture complex non-linear relationships without explicit feature engineering.

### B. Performance Metrics Summary

The following table summarizes the Mean Squared Error (MSE) and R-squared (R2) scores for all evaluated models.

TABLE IV  
MODEL PERFORMANCE METRICS

| Model                                | MSE      | R2       |
|--------------------------------------|----------|----------|
| 1. Inverse LSQ (Volt. Div w/o ADC)   | 0.6612   | 0.9977   |
| 2. Inverse LSQ (Wheatstone w/ ADC)   | 0.009941 | 0.999953 |
| 3. LSQ (Wheatstone w/ ADC)           | 0.009198 | 0.999956 |
| 4. SGD Regressor (Wheatstone w/ ADC) | 0.030477 | 0.999854 |
| 5. Inverse SGD (Wheatstone w/ ADC)   | 0.016221 | 0.999922 |
| 6. Random Forest (Wheatstone w/ ADC) | 1.248897 | 0.994033 |

### C. Validation Data and Model Predictions (Subset)

The below table presents a small subset of test data, showing the actual and predicted temperature values for the Voltage Divider setup.

TABLE V  
VOLTAGE DIVIDER VALIDATION TABLE WITH PREDICTIONS

| Voltage | Actual Temperature | Prediction |
|---------|--------------------|------------|
| 2.7300  | 39.7               | 40.9900    |
| 2.7500  | 46.4               | 45.6500    |
| 2.8400  | 68.3               | 68.8900    |
| 2.8920  | 85.6               | 84.7100    |
| 2.9100  | 90.0               | 90.8000    |
| 2.8700  | 77.8               | 77.7400    |

The following table presents a small subset of the test data, showing the actual temperature values alongside the predictions from the Random Forest, Inverse LSQ, LSQ, SGD, and Inverse SGD Regressor models for the Wheatstone bridge setup with ADC.

TABLE VI  
WHEATSTONE VALIDATION DATA AND PREDICTIONS

| Volt (V) | Actual (°C) | Inv LSQ (ADC) | LSQ (ADC) | SGD (ADC) | Inv SGD (ADC) | RF (ADC) |
|----------|-------------|---------------|-----------|-----------|---------------|----------|
| 0.2634   | 51.9        | 51.9136       | 51.9070   | 51.7938   | 51.9906       | 53.3456  |
| 0.3127   | 65.9        | 65.7972       | 65.8329   | 65.7442   | 65.8829       | 67.6248  |
| 0.2083   | 37.2        | 37.1962       | 37.1906   | 37.2964   | 37.1134       | 37.0563  |
| 0.4037   | 93.1        | 93.6290       | 93.4194   | 93.9231   | 93.2383       | 89.0505  |
| 0.2092   | 37.5        | 37.4305       | 37.4238   | 37.5239   | 37.3513       | 37.0563  |
| 0.2978   | 61.6        | 61.5231       | 61.5485   | 61.4304   | 61.6219       | 61.8901  |
| 0.2028   | 35.8        | 35.7687       | 35.7707   | 35.9127   | 35.6628       | 36.7501  |
| 0.2666   | 52.7        | 52.7931       | 52.7892   | 52.6712   | 52.8748       | 53.3456  |
| 0.3185   | 67.5        | 67.4803       | 67.5183   | 67.4462   | 67.5568       | 68.7954  |
| 0.2850   | 57.9        | 57.9067       | 57.9202   | 57.7921   | 58.0053       | 58.6497  |

### D. Graphical Comparison of Wheatstone ADC Models

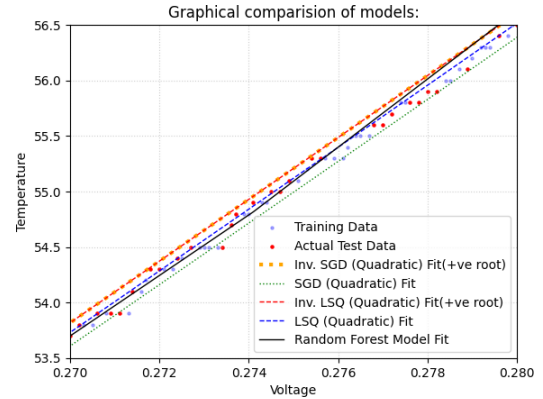


Fig. 2. Comparison of Random Forest, Inverse LSQ, LSQ, SGD and Inverse SGD Regressor predictions against actual test data for the Wheatstone bridge with ADC for temperatures between 53.5°C to 56.5°C

### E. Model Comparison and Conclusion

Comparing the performance metrics, the Least Squares (Quadratic) model for the Wheatstone bridge achieved the highest R-squared score of 0.999956. It also achieved the lowest mean squared error of 0.009198. Qualitatively, we can say that the **Least Squares Quadratic** model is the best at predicting the temperature.

## V. APPENDIX - DATA COLLECTION USING OPTICAL CHARACTER RECOGNITION (OCR)

This script uses OpenCV and EasyOCR to capture video from a webcam, identify and read text from two specific regions (voltage and temperature in this case), and log this data to a file.

It is designed to be calibrated for a specific, fixed-camera setup, such as this case where we are reading data from an LCD screen and a separate standard thermometer.

### A. Getting Started

Follow these instructions to get the script up and running on your local machine.

1) **Prerequisites:** Before you run the script, you'll need a few things set up.

#### Hardware:

- A webcam connected to your computer.
- **(Not necessary)** An NVIDIA GPU with CUDA installed. The script is pre-set to use `gpu=True` for much faster processing.

#### Software:

- Python 3.x
- The required Python libraries: `opencv-python` [8], `easyocr` [9], and `numpy` [10].

2) **A Note on the Webcam (Optional):** This script will work with any webcam that OpenCV can detect, including built-in laptop cameras or standard USB webcams. The most important factor is a stable, well-positioned camera.

For reference, the development and testing for this project were done using a virtual camera setup:

- DroidCam [11]: An application to use a smartphone as a high-quality webcam.
- OBS Studio [12]: This software was used to capture the DroidCam feed and output it as an "OBS Virtual Camera," which was then selected by the Python script.

Again, this specific setup is not required. It is just one example of how to provide a camera feed to the script. Any simple webcam will work perfectly fine.

#### 3) Installation:

- **Create a Directory for Images:** The script is hardcoded to save debug images to an `img/` folder. You must create this folder in the same directory as the script for the program to run.

```
1 mkdir img
```

- **Install Python Libraries:** Install the necessary packages using `pip`:

```
1 pip install opencv-python easyocr numpy
```

**Note:** `easyocr` [9] will also install `PyTorch` [13], which is a large download and a required dependency.

### B. How to Run

1. Make sure your webcam is plugged in and positioned correctly to see both your target readings.
2. Open a terminal and navigate to the folder containing `a.py`.
3. Run the script:

```
1 python3 a.py
```
4. Two windows will appear: 'Voltage' and 'Temperature'. These show the exact (and processed) regions being sent to the OCR engine.
5. To stop the script, make sure one of these windows is active (click on it) and **press the 'q' key**.

### C. Important: Calibration is Required!

This script **will not work correctly** without calibration. You must adjust the code to fit your specific camera, lighting, and display setup.

Here are the key sections you **must** modify in `a.py`:

1) **GPU Usage:** If you **do not** have a compatible NVIDIA GPU, you must change this line:

```
1 # From:
2 reader = easyocr.Reader(['en'], gpu=True)
3
4 # To:
5 reader = easyocr.Reader(['en'], gpu=False)
```

The script will run much slower on the CPU but will still function.

2) **Frame Cropping:** This is the most critical part. You need to tell the script exactly where to look for your data.

```
1 #Change the crop values according to requirement
2 voltage_frame = frame[0:int(h/2), :]
3 temp_frame = frame[int(h/2):, 0:int(w/3)]
```

Python slices are in `[y1:y2, x1:x2]` format (rows, then columns).

`voltage_frame` is currently set to the top half of the entire camera feed.

`temp_frame` is set to the bottom-left third of the feed.

You must change these pixel/percentage values to precisely isolate your voltage and temperature readings. The Voltage and Temperature windows will show you what the script sees in these cropped zones, so you can adjust the values and re-run until they are correct.

#### 3) Image Processing:

##### • Temperature

```
1 #These values need to be calibrated according to
   requirement
2 gray_t = cv2.cvtColor(temp_frame, cv2.COLOR_BGR2GRAY)
3
4 t_lower = 50
5 t_upper = 100
6 _,thres = cv2.threshold(gray_t,130, 255, cv2.
   THRESH_BINARY_INV)
7 kernel = cv2.getStructuringElement(cv2.MORPH_RECT,
   (11,11))
8 closed_img = cv2.morphologyEx(thres, cv2.MORPH_CLOSE
   , kernel)
9 pretemp = cv2.bitwise_not(closed_img)
10 temp = cv2.GaussianBlur(pretemp, (17,17), 0)
```

Key Values to Change:

- `cv2.threshold(gray_t, 130, 255, cv2.THRESH_BINARY_INV)`: The 130 is the threshold value. This is highly sensitive to lighting. Adjust it up or down until the text is clearly separated from the background in the 'Temperature' window.
- `cv2.getStructuringElement(cv2.MORPH_RECT, (11, 11))`: This is the kernel size for the 'closing' operation, which helps connect broken parts of a number. You may need to make it larger or smaller.
- `cv2.GaussianBlur(pretemp, (17, 17), 0)`: This is the kernel size for the blur.

Look at the Temperature window while calibrating. Your goal is to make the numbers you want to read clear and solid, while removing as much background noise as possible.

It is also preferred to hide the decimal point, either physically or by further image processing.

- **Voltage** In this case, the cropped voltage frame, is converted to grayscale before it is used for OCR. Make sure the voltage reading is visible in the voltage frame. It is also preferred to hide the decimal point, either physically or by further image processing.

#### D. Data Collection Methodology

The dataset is collected by simulating a **real-world thermal change (cooling cycle)** to capture paired temperature readings.

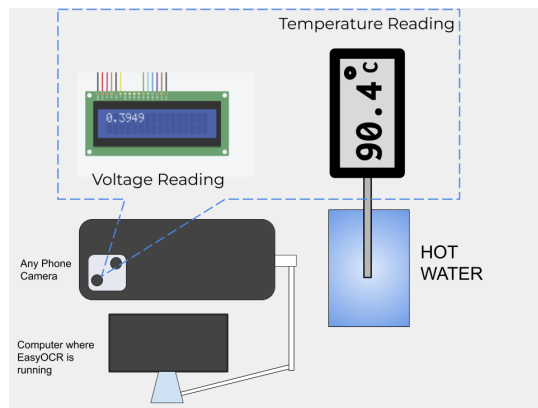


Fig. 3. Auto-Trainer representation

#### 1. Setup:

- Place both the PT100 probe and the reference thermometer inside an electric kettle, submerged in water.

#### 2. Heating Phase:

- Turn on the kettle and heat the water to its boiling point.

#### 3. Recording Phase:

- Switch off the kettle at boiling point.
- Start recording a **video** using the smartphone.
- Ensure **both the PT100 LCD display and reference thermometer** are visible in the frame.

#### 4. Cooling Phase:

- Continue recording the cooling process as the water temperature drops naturally.

#### 5. Data Extraction:

- The recorded video acts as the raw dataset.
- Extract frames and apply **OCR (Optical Character Recognition)** to detect readings from both displays.

#### E. Output

The script generates two types of output:

- `out.txt`: A text file that logs the detected readings. Every 15 frames, if text is found in both regions, a new line is added, formatted as: [voltage\_reading] [temperature\_reading]
- `img/` Directory: This folder saves `voltageXX.png` and `tempXX.png` images. These are the exact frames that were sent to EasyOCR. If you are getting bad readings, check these images to see why. They are perfect for debugging your calibration and fixing the readings.

`out.txt` is not perfect due to some instances of incorrect character recognition. The data was manually updated and is saved in `trainingdata.txt`. The final training data is in the following text file

<https://github.com/gadepall/pt100/blob/main/AutoTrainer/trainingdata.txt>

## VI. APPENDIX - ARDUINO DEPLOYMENT

Following are the steps to upload code to the Arduino

1) Connect Arduino to computer via USB

2) Upload the following code to the Arduino  
<https://github.com/gadepall/pt100/blob/main/codes/arduino/code/code.ino>

The Arduino code,

- Finds the voltage across PT100 through the ADC
- Predicts the temperature from the voltage with the model.
- Displays the temperature on the LCD display.

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